

You can also activate the theme from the **Appearance > Themes** page.

The WordPress Admin interface for installing themes. Once you have installed the theme (and optionally activated it), you can make theme modifications with CSS or adjust the code as needed. Once you activate it, you can customize it further with widgets.

WordPress with a theme that is configured to use widget, but with no widgets configured, has a default layout for the sidebar. This is coded according to the wishes of the theme designer but disappears once any widget is configured for use.

If you don't want to use the WordPress Admin to install a new theme, or if you want to use a theme not currently listed in the WordPress repository (there are still many themes that have not been added to the repository, are not necessarily under the General Public License (GPL), or are custom designed and made), you can manually upload your theme. To do this, follow these steps:

1. Download the theme zip file from the WordPress Themes Directory or third-party download site.
2. Extract the zip file. This creates a folder with all the theme files inside it.
3. Upload the theme via FTP or SFTP to the `/wp-content/themes` folder. For example, if the theme folder is called `cool-theme/`, you would upload the folder and end up with `/wp-content/themes/cool-theme/`.
4. From the WordPress Admin, choose **Appearance > Themes**.
5. To Preview the theme before activating it, click the Preview link below your new theme. To activate the theme without previewing it first, skip to Step 7.
6. To activate the theme from the Preview window, click the Activate link in the upper right corner.
7. To activate the theme without previewing it first, click the Activate link under the theme listing.

4.3 Finding and implementing premium themes

Theme designers in the WordPress community are split down the GPL line. From the Automattic side of the house (the main proprietor of WordPress), there is no endorsement of premium themes (whether by explicit blessing or by implicit inclusion in the Themes Directory). In fact, this side of the argument has been historically hostile to the use of premium themes.

This position is based largely on some historical abuses by premium theme developers that carry licenses requiring inclusion of links back to the